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Education

University of Southern California

Ph.D. Economics (expected) 2027

M.A. Economics 2023

Tsinghua University

B.A. Economics and Finance 2019

Fields

Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

References

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Job Market Paper

Time Is of the Essence: Experimental Evidence on the Effects of Job Application Timing

This paper studies the role of job application timing in recruitment. Repurposing the correspondence experiment of Kline, Rose and Walters (2022), I show that, holding vacancy and resume content fixed, first-half experimental applications have a contact rate 1.16 percentage points higher, equivalent to 57 percent of the Black-White contact gap in the same setting. Each day earlier raises contact probability by 0.40 percentage points. The key mechanism is that firms often begin contacting while applications are still being received. Using randomized resume attributes, I instrument whether contact has already begun with the highest predicted contact probability among previously submitted applications. Stronger prior applications trigger earlier initiation, and IV estimates confirm a post-initiation contact penalty. The timing gradient is steeper in tighter labor markets. A sequential model separates applicant arrival rates from the shadow cost of delay and quantifies firms' tradeoff between earlier contact and the screening-value gains from waiting. Conditional on the firm contacting an experimental application, the highest-ranked application has not yet arrived in 51.6 percent of cases, yielding a 6.6 percent loss relative to the contact-initiating application's expected screening value. Together, the results provide the first large-scale causal evidence that firms' sequential contact decisions make queue position consequential within vacancies, revealing an employer-side margin through which labor market conditions shape who is considered.

Working Papers

When Hierarchies Teach: Selective Review and Decision Alignment in U.S. Asylum Courts *with Daniel L. Chen*

Review by a higher authority evaluates experts' first-instance decisions and informs their subsequent choices, but this feedback is selectively generated. We study this process in U.S. asylum courts, where feedback follows a denial, applicant appeal, and Board of Immigration Appeals (BIA) disposition. Using linked immigration-court and BIA records from 1986 to 2019, we develop a rolling prediction model to distinguish expected from surprise reversals using information available to judges before appellate resolution. Weekly event studies show a 1.57-percentage-point larger first-week increase in lower-court grant rates after surprise than after expected reversals, with no broad decline in observable hearing-diligence proxies. We develop a threshold model of response magnitude and distributional alignment with the BIA standard. Marginal treatment effects (MTEs) show that reversal rates among denied cases vary less with judge leniency for high-response than low-response judges. The model interprets this pattern as closer alignment with the BIA standard, especially where decision thresholds are stricter. The pattern appears on both appeal filing among denials and BIA success conditional on appeal, with the clearest contrast on appeal filing. This alignment gap is smaller in defensive than affirmative proceedings, consistent with structured hearings making feedback more usable. Review's teaching function therefore depends on feedback selection, signal diagnosticity, and recipient responsiveness.

From AI Exposure to Training Access: Evidence from U.S. Workforce Boards

I link 2017-2024 administrative records from local boards under the Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA) to training provider listings and state funding to provide new empirical evidence on how public training systems respond to post-GenAI changes in expected skill demand. After ChatGPT's launch in 2022, boards serving more AI-exposed workers and with greater prior experience show a 3-percentage-point larger rise in training participation, about 30 additional trainees per 1,000 participants. Training content shifts much less toward AI-related fields. Eligible-provider listings expand, but listed programs do not automatically translate into funded AI training. The access response is larger in state-years with greater formula allotments, and training activity becomes more concentrated in boards with established routines. The findings show that public workforce systems can expand access when resources and delivery experience are in place. Targeted AI retraining, however, depends on whether those systems convert provider availability and fiscal support into funded participation.

Work in Progress

Employer Networks as Organizational Capital in Professional Education: Evidence from U.S. Law Schools

Reallocating Expertise in the AI Era: Evidence from the U.S. Patent Office

Delegation under Deadlines: Evidence from U.S. Patent Prosecution

Strategic Predictability: Theory and Evidence from Professional Tennis

Beyond the Altar: Catholic Convents and Gender Norms in the United States, 1850-1940 *with Monia Tomasella and Juan David Torres*

Awards and Fellowships	Second Century Manning Fellowship, USC Graduate School	2026–2027
	Graduate School Fellowship, USC	2021–2025
	Outstanding Second-Year Paper Award, USC	2023
Research Grants	Department of Economics Research Grant, USC – \$10,000	2024
	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies – \$3,000	2024
Research Positions	Research Assistant to Vittorio Bassi, USC	2023–2024
	Research Assistant to Augustin Bergeron, USC	2023–2024
	Research Assistant to Timothy Armstrong, USC	2022–2023
	Predocctoral Researcher, AQR Asset Management Institute, London Business School (supervisor: Stephen Schaefer)	2019–2021
	Research Assistant (remote) to Daniel L. Chen (Toulouse School of Economics) and Elliott Ash (ETH Zurich)	2018–2021
Teaching	Teaching Assistant, USC	
	<i>Microeconomic Theory II</i> (Ph.D. core)	Spring 2025
	<i>Principles of Microeconomics</i> (undergraduate)	Fall 2022, 2024
	<i>Economic Consulting and Applied Managerial Economics</i> (undergraduate)	Spring 2023
Presentations	2026: Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, 5th Workshop in Applied Microeconomics (AMIE), 8th QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop for PhD & Post-doctoral Students, USC (seminar), California State University, Long Beach (seminar), ALEA Annual Meeting, Conference on Empirical Legal Studies 2025: PolMeth Europe, WEAI's 100th Annual Conference, Emerging Scholars Symposium (Pomona College), 6th World Labor Conference, 3rd Annual AEA CSQIEP Mentoring Conference, 20th Economics Graduate Student Conference (Washington University in St. Louis) 2024: 17th All-California Labor Economics Conference 2023: 16th All-California Labor Economics Conference, 1st USC Economics PhD Alumni Conference	
Academic Service	Organizer, USC Economics Brownbag Seminar Series	2025–2026
	Organizer, 6th Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics	2023
	Conference reviewer, European Association of Young Economists (EAYE) Annual Meeting	2026, 2023
Training	Selected participant, Price Theory Summer Camp, University of Chicago	2024
Software Skills	Stata, Python, R, Julia, C/C++, MATLAB, QGIS, SQL, Git, $\LaTeX$	
Languages	English (proficient), Mandarin (native)	
Citizenship	China (F-1 visa)	